Portuguese for Mozambican Mothers – A Language Empowerment App

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Problem Statement

In Mecúfi, Mozambique, the mothers of children who attend school through the DIFF EDUCATION program have a strong desire to learn Portuguese, the country's national language due to colonization. However, they have minimal formal education and little to no experience with technology. They are unable to read or write in any language, including their native language Makhuwa, making many current educational resources unusable. This leaves these mothers without accessible, culturally relevant tools to help address their linguistic needs.





Abstract

This project focuses on developing an educational application designed for non-literate mothers in rural Mozambique. The app emphasizes visual and auditory learning to accommodate users with no prior experience with reading or technology. To ensure usability in areas with limited internet connectivity, the app's critical learning features function offline. Designed for group learning with a moderator, the app does not require individual logins and provides immediate feedback on exercises.



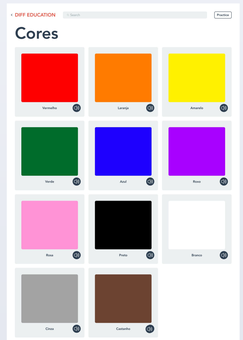


Project Design

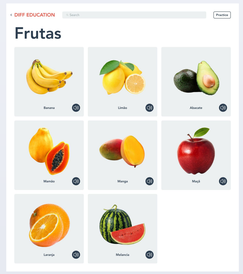
- **User-Centered Approach**: Simple design with audio and visuals that reflect the local population.
- **Offline Functionality**: Ensures accessibility in areas with unstable internet.
- **Moderated Learning**: Focuses on guided group learning rather than individual navigation.
- **Interactive Elements**: Immediate feedback on exercises without requiring individual tracking.
- **Vocabulary Focus**: Prioritizes frequently used words relevant to daily life.



Learn Landing Page



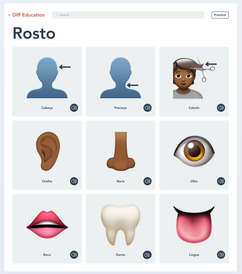
Set with Blocks



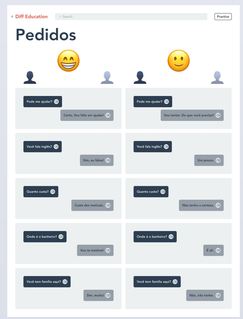
Set with Photos



Set with Graphics



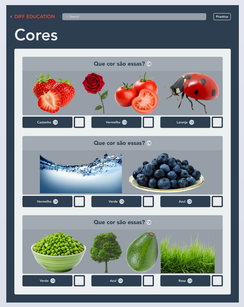
Set with Emojis



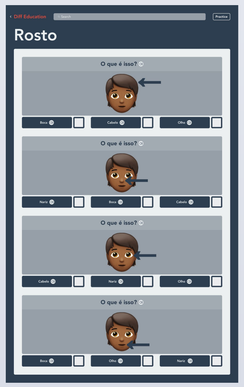
Set with Dialogue Pairs



Practice Landing Page



Quiz with Photos



Quiz with Emojis



Practice Conversation

Outcomes

- **Enhanced Learning Accessibility**: Enables mothers to engage in language learning despite literacy and technology barriers.
- **Culturally Inclusive Design**: Use of illustrations and audio ensures local relevance and relatability.
- **Scalability & Adaptability**: The model can be expanded to include more content.
- **Community Impact**: Strengthens social learning and interaction among participants.







Conclusion

By addressing key constraints such as literacy, technology familiarity, and internet access, this project provides an innovative solution for language learning in rural Mozambique. The app fosters a supportive learning environment through group engagement and moderator-led exercises, ultimately promoting greater educational access and empowerment for non-literate mothers.



Next Steps

- Conduct app testing with DIFF EDUCATION mothers to refine usability.
- Expand vocabulary sections based on moderator and user feedback, as well as daily communication needs.
- Create moderator training materials to improve facilitation quality.
- Design tutorials to teach users how to use the app independently.

Acknowledgments

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DIFF EDUCATION Children's EDUCATION for a DIFFerent World

Frugal InnovationHub — Santa Clara University School of Engineering

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